Definition of Management

Management is the function of getting things done through people an d directing the efforts of individuals towards a common objective.

Management is the art of maximizing efficiency, as a social process, a method of getting things done through others. A plan of action and its direction by a co-operative group moving towards a common goal.

Effective utilisation of available resources to achieve same objective is management.

Management is a comprehensive function of Planning, Organising, For ecasting Coordinating, Leading, Controlling, Motivating the efforts of others to achieve specific objectives. Management can precisely be cal led the rule – making and rule – enforcing body.

Definition of management by management scholars

Management Scholars have different definitions of management as foll ows:

George Terry being a little more elaborate defined management as 'a di stinct process consisting of planning, organizing, actuating and contr olling performed to determine and accomplish the objectives by the us e of people and resources'
Williams (2018) simply defined Management as getting work done thro ugh others. Just like George Terry, management is also seen as a proce ss by Bateman et al. (2018) who defined management as a process of working with people and resources to accomplish organisational goal s. Good managers do those things both effectively and efficiently.

Griffin (2013) listed the needed resourcing being combined to attain or ganisational goal, thus he defined management as a set of activities (i ncluding planning and decision making, organizing, leading, and contr olling) directed at an organisation's resources (human, financial, physi cal, and information), with the aim of achieving organisational goals in an efficient and effective manner.
Schulze (2012) emphasized the importance of leadership in manageme nt, according to him, management is 'the force which leads, guides an d directs an organisation in the accomplishment of a pre-determined o

bject'.

Stanley Vance highlighted the functions of a manager by defining man agement as 'the process of decision-making and control over the actio ns of human beings for the express purpose of attaining predetermine d goals'.

Kinicki & Williams (2018) defined management as (1) the pursuit of org anisational goals efficiently and effectively by (2) integrating the work of people through (3) planning, organizing, leading, and controlling th e organisation's resources.

The Purpose of Management

The purpose of management is to serve customers. Yet, if one looks thr ough most management books for a definition of management, 99.9 pe rcent of the time, the word customer will not be mentioned. This is ast onishing because serving customers in order to obtain a profit is the cr ux of every business organization.

Good managers constantly streamline their organizations toward maki ng a sale. In other words, good managers are needed to keep their org anizations on track by ensuring that everything that's being done is et hically geared toward providing what customers want. In this regard, a good manager is responsible for reducing waste and ambiguity, keepin g costs down, and motivating others to do the same.

Management is needed in order to coordinate the activities of a busine ss and make sure all employees are working together toward the acco mplishment of the organization's goals.

Management is needed to inject motivation, creativity, discipline, and enthusiasm into areas in which they either don't exist or they're not ne cessarily wanted.

Management is also needed for the formation and implementation of b usiness policies and strategies.

Characteristics of Management

1. Management is Goal Oriented
2. Management is interdisciplinary: it's both science & Arts

3. Management involves decision making
4. Management involves leading people i.e., group activity

Management is goal oriented: The pre-determined objective of the organisation is always the focus of the manager and he directs all a ctivities towards achieving these objectives.

Management is interdisciplinary: Apart from management drawing i deas from different fields it is basically an Arts because principles ar e set. Also, it is a science because through the application of set pri nciples pre-determined objective are attained.

Management involves decision making: The fact that managers liais e with external bodies and interacts with other employees places th em at an advantage to gather sufficient information for decision ma king. The quality of decision made by managers affect the overall su ccess of the organisation which makes decision making very vital to any establishment.

Management involves leading people: If there are no human beings involved, there is basically nothing to manage. Available resources a re meant for the use of human beings. The manager therefore requir es managerial skills/leadership skills such as communication skills and ability to motivate others. In management, there must be a gro up/activity centred around common objectives being carried out by a group of people.

Functions of management

The various functions of management are classified as:

- Planning
- Organizing
- Staffing
- Leading/Directing

- Controlling/Monitoring
- Motivation

Functions of Management

Kumar (2012) citing L. Gulick and L. Urwick (1937) listed the functions of management

as

- Planning
- Organizing
- Directing
- Co-ordinating
- Staffing
- Budgeting
- Reporting

Planning

Planning for managers is mandatory. It is commonly said that you plan to fail if you're without a plan. There is always a need to plan towards a chieving the desired goal. You can re-strategize if your first plan fails.

Kumar (2012) indicated that systematic planning involves some steps.

(a) Identifying an existing problem and the need for action

(b) Gathering of information as much as possible about the nature of t he existing problem.

(c) Assessment of possible alternatives on how to solve the problem.

(d) Taking decision on possible action to take

(e) Taking action by rolling out & performing activities

(f) Evaluation of solution at every stage to ensure its efficacy.

Organizing

After the initial plan that helps one to set out specific objectives, there is a need to develop structures that are interrelated that is hierarchical in nature. Usually, this type of structure forms the organisational struc ture of any establishment bringing out patterns of relationships amon g staff and available resources in order to achieve stated objectives. Ku mar (2012) citing Peter Drucker stated that organisations have differen t structures and identified three determinants of the suitability of orga nisational structure for a particular organisation as.

(a) Activities analysis
(b) Decision analysis
(c) Relations analysis .

Directing

This has to do with rolling out activities to be carried out by different p eople and instructing them on how to go about it. The success of a ma nager at the level of directing, depends on his leadership skills. For ma ximum productivity the manager and other employee must have the sa me focus, i.e. they must believe in the same mission. In order to achiev e this the manager must be able to carry all employees concerned alon g to get them adequately motivated. The manager must also have goo d communication skills to be able to persuade other employees. In dire cting, decision making is important. The process of decision making in volves the following steps.
(a) Identifying occasions for decision making.
(b) Identifying possible courses of actions that could be taken.
(c) Choosing one course of action out of the possible options.

Coordinating

Most authorities recognize just five functions of management as plann ing, organisation, staffing, directing and controlling as such coordinati on is subsumed in all the functions.

However, coordination has to do with the interrelation of various parts for harmonious operation.

Reporting

The fact that, no one is working alone means that there are superior au thorities you need to report to. These people in higher authority need t o be informed about how well the organisation is faring using predeter mined procedures, policies etc. Onus is on the manager to carry both t he administrators and other subordinates along through proper report ing.

Budgeting

A budget is the money that is available to a person or an organization and a plan of how it will be spent over a period of time (Oxford Advanc e Learner's Dictionary, 2015). Budgeting which requires careful plannin g, accounting and control is an effective management tool that deals with fund allocation.

Staffing

Human resource is very important in every organisation. Staffing has t wo aspects: technical and social. The technical aspect of staffing deals with performance evaluation, job analysis etc. while the social aspect deals with staff welfare such as training, promotion etc. Apart from rec ruiting qualified staff, managers must maintain them to ensure that th ey are retained.

Controlling

This is where monitoring and evaluation sets into the manager's functi ons. At every stage, the manager is monitoring activities to ensure that they conform to set standards, he is also measuring performance to kn ow if they are within targets and moving towards expected results. The manager can also make adjustments along the way based on his obser vations.

What is a management style?

A management style is a way in which a manager works to fulfil their g

oals. Management style includes the way that a manager plans, organi zes, makes decisions, delegates, and manages their staff.

It can vary widely depending on the company, level of management, in dustry, country, and culture, as well as the staff themselves.

An effective manager is someone who can adjust their management s tyle in response to different factors while keeping their focus on succe ssfully achieving targets.

Types of management styles

There are three main categories of management styles, namely: **Autocr atic, democratic and laissez-faire.**

Within these categories, there are specific **subtypes** of management st yles, each with its own advantages and disadvantages.

1. Autocratic management styles

This type of management follows a top-down approach, with one-way communication from bosses to employees. It is also known as Authorit arian management style.

This is the most controlling of the different management styles, with t he management making all workplace decisions and holding all of the power. Employees are treated as drones, to be monitored closely as th ey perform within clearly defined perimeters.

Employees are not encouraged to ask questions, submit ideas, or shar e their thoughts on improving processes, and are in some cases activel y discouraged from doing so.

The subtypes of autocratic management style are authoritative, persua sive, and paternalistic.

a. Authoritative management style

In this style, managers dictate exactly what they require their subordin ates to do and punish those who do not comply.

Employees are expected to take orders, not question the authority of management, and perform their tasks the same way each time.

Managers monitor the employees closely, micromanaging their perfor mance without placing trust or confidence that their employees can a chieve their goals without direct and constant supervision. These type s of managers believe that without this supervision, employees will no t operate successfully.

Advantages:

(1) This management style allows quick decision making, and creat es clearly defined roles and expectations.

(2) With unskilled workers or large teams, setting clear and solid ex pectations can allow workers to operate without uncertainty.

(3) Productivity will increase, but only when the manager is presen t.

(4) Enhance Accountability as team members are held accountable for their action and performance, promoting a sense of responsibili ty and ownership.

(5) Reduce conflict, this management style can resolve conflict eff ectively,maintaining a positive and productive team dynamic beca use of their kind of leadership skills.

Disadvantages:

The negatives of authoritative management style include;

(1) An increase in the dissatisfaction of employees, which leads to higher turnover of resentment, a lack of professional development and employee engagement, and the formation of an 'us' versus 'th em' mentality between employees and management.

(2) Innovation is stifled and inefficient processes will remain in plac e.

(3) Foster fear and intimidation due to this kind of management sty le, it can create a culture of fear, where team members or employee s are reluctant to speak up or share their concerns.

(4) Inhabit Open communication; Authoritative leaders may not en courage open and honest communication, leading to unresolved is sues and conflicts due to lack of communication and self expressio n.

b. Persuasive management style

In this style, managers use their persuasive skills to convince employe es that the unilateral decisions that the manager implements are for th e good of the team, department, or organization.

Rather than simply ordering employees to perform tasks, managers e mploying this style would invite questions and would explain the decis ion-making process and rationale behind policies. This can help emplo yees feel as though they are a more trusted and valued part of the staff and are involved in key business decisions, leading to lower levels of re sentment or tension between management and staff.

Advantages:

(1) Management can establish a higher level of trust between them selves and employees.

(2) Employees will accept top-down decisions more easily.

(3) Employees respond more positively to reason and logic than th ey do the threat of punishment, and may feel less constricted than those managed with an authoritative style.

(4) Enhance Adaptability, this style foster adaptability, encourage t eam members to be flexible and responsive to changing circumsta nces.

(5) Build Trust, persuasive management or leadership style build tr ust with their team members, creating a positive and supportive w ork environment.

Disadvantages:

(1) Employees will still struggle under the restrictions they are plac ed on, and become frustrated that they cannot give feedback, crea te solutions, or upskill in a meaningful way.

(2) Can be time consuming as the may spend too much time trying to convince team members rather than taking decisive action.

(3) Can lead to burn out. Persuasive management style may experi ence burn out if they are constantly trying to persuade and motiva te team members.

(4) Persuasive management style can be seen as manipulative or in sincere if they use this style tactics to get what they want which c an lead to distrust from the employees towards the manager.

c. Paternalistic management style

In this style, the manager acts with the best interests of their subordin ates at heart. Usually, the organization will refer to staff as 'family' and ask for loyalty and trust from employees.

Management using this style will use unilateral decision making but wi ll explain to employees that the decision-makers are working from a pl

ace of expertise, and thus, legitimacy. Decisions are explained to empl oyees, but there is no room for collaboration or questioning.

Advantages:

(1) A paternalistic manager is focused on the welfare of their emplo yees, and will base their decisions on what is best for their staff.

(2) Upskilling and employee education are valued, leading to happi er, more skilled, more productive employees.

(3) Foster long term relationship, as this style builds long term rela tionship with team mmembers, creating a sense of stability and co ntinuity.

(4) Enhance unity, paternalistic style enhance unity, co-operation among staff.

Disadvantages:

(1) Employees can become too dependent on management, leadin g to a lack of innovation and problem-solving.

(2) There is a high chance of this style breeding resentment among employees who do not believe in the 'organization as family' conce pt.

(3) Employees might find this style condescending and infantilizin g.

(4) Can create Conflicts, as leaders may create Conflict among em ployees, particularly if they perceive favouritism or unequal treatm ent.

2. Democratic management styles

In this style, managers encourage employees to give input during the decision-making process, but are ultimately responsible for the final d ecision.

Communication goes both ways, top-down and down-up, and team co hesiveness is increased.

This process allows for diverse opinions, skills and ideas to inform deci sions, and encourage employees to input extensively during decision making process. It also has the following substyles:

a. **Consultative management style**

In this style, managers ask for the opinions and thoughts of their team, consulting the viewpoints of every member of their team.

The manager will make the final decision, but they will consider all of t he information given by team members before they do so.

This style is often used in specialized fields, like the "library" where sta ff are experts and their input is needed for the management to make in formed decisions.

Advantages:

(1) This style promotes a deeper bond between staff and managem ent, and builds trust within teams.

(2) Management grows with the team, as they learn from the ideas, opinions and experience of the employees that they lead.

(3) Innovation and voicing opinions are encouraged, leading to bet ter problem-solving.

(4) Improve decision-making. Consultative management involves s

eeking input from others, ensuring that decision are informed by di verse perspective and expertise.

(5) It increases job satisfaction as employees feel valued.

Disadvantages:

(1) The process of consulting staff can be labour and time-intensiv e.

(2) If a manager is not skilled in the time management aspect of thi s process, they can easily get bogged down.

(3) If there is an appearance of favouritism or bosses not listening t o opinions, employees may become resentful and distrustful of the manager.

(4) Excessive reliance on this style can lead to staff losing trust in t heir boss, as they will start to wonder why they are always called o n to help solve problems instead of management handling it as par t of their job.

(5) This style may not be effective for urgent task where swift actio n and decision -making are necessary.

b. Participative management style

In this style, managers and staff are all active members of the decision process. Staff are given access to more information about the compan y and its goals, and are encouraged to innovate solutions.

Management seeks the thoughts, ideas and opinions of staff, works to gether with staff to make decisions and then the company acts on the m.

Advantages:

(1) Employees feel as though they are valued by their management team and the organization as a whole, and will respond with increa sed motivation and productivity.

(2) The more they understand and connect with the organization's goals, the higher their engagement will be. Innovation is increased.

(3) Increase job satisfaction of the employees as their thoughts an d opinions are heard, towards a successful achievement of the org anization.

(4) Foster unity and team collaboration, as everyone wants to be a ctively involved in the progress of the organization.

Disadvantages:

(1) This process can be a slow one, and there is a risk of staff with b igger personalities steamrolling less assertive staff members, leadi ng to conflicts and resentment.

(2) In industries with trade secrets, letting staff have access to sen sitive information can be risky.

(3) If employees do not want to be involved in this type of decision making, they can grow to resent managers who employ this style.

(4) this management style can lead to lack of respect, as employee s begin to see their manager as incapable towards handling and m aking decisions without always seeking their active participation u nless for a few.

c. Collaborative management style

In this style, management creates an open forum for ideas to be discus sed extensively before making decisions based on majority rule.

Staff is empowered to take ownership of outcomes, which can lead to i

ncreased engagement, innovation and creativity.

Advantages:

(1) Staff feels trusted, valued and heard by all levels of their manag ement team.

(2) They are inspired to put forth their best work, find collaborative solutions to problems, and engage completely with the process.

(3) Open communication means that workplace conflicts are often solved before real issues arise.

(4)Turnover is decreased when employees are engaged, and divers e voices often lead to better solutions and outcomes.

(5) Enhance informed decision making, as the manager gets inform ation and direct ideas from employees, and way them for best resu lt to be attained .

Disadvantages:

(1) As with other democratic management styles, this process can be time-consuming.

(2) Majority rule can also not always be the best choice for an orga nization, and if there is a decision that is not in the best interests o f the business, management will need to step in and change it, whi ch can breed resentment and mistrust.

(3) This style is mostly not effective in situations that needs urgent decision to be made.

(4) Employees may experience burn out, as the are expected to ma ke input aalways and sometimes may also require them to stay up more than their work hour.

d. Transformational management style

This style of management is agile and growth-focused.

Managers focus their efforts on pushing their staff to ever greater accomplishments through encouragement, pushing them past their comfort zones regularly, and consistently motivating their teams to raise their bar for achievements. Managers work alongside with their employees, inspiring their team to ever greater efforts by demonstrating their own work ethic.

Advantages:

(1) Innovation is increased, and employees will more easily adapt to changes, disruptions, or challenging projects.

(2)Creative thinking is encouraged, and problem-solving and product development will benefit from the increased flexibility of the staff.

(3) acquisition of new skills (upskilling) is encouraged towards the good of the employees this time around, not just for the growth of the organization.

(4) this management style ensures that employees attain their greatest potentials for the future ahead of them in and outside the organization.

Disadvantages:

(1) If not used carefully, this style will cause staff to burn out.

(2) Staff may end up spread too thin, worn out from constantly pushing themselves, and unable to keep up with the pace.

(3) Some staff may not like this management style, as the do not like to live their comfort zone.

(4) This management style while trying to push their employees to their greatest potentials, it may lead to turnover of the employees as the may forget that there is a need for the employees to take a b reak.

e. Coaching management style

In this style, managers see themselves as the coach and their employe es as the valued members of their team.

The manager's job is to develop and guide their team, putting their tea m's professional development at the forefront of their priorities. Long-term development is valued above short-term failures in this style, and the manager wants to promote learning, upskilling and growing in the workplace.

Advantages:

(1) Employees feel valued, they know that they will learn and devel op within their roles, and are more likely to be engaged.

(2) Managers build a strong bond with their employees, who will in turn be more likely to put forth their best work for their 'coach'.

(3) Stronger Accountability, By focusing on goal setting and perfor mance, coaching leaders help employees understand their role and responsibilities, fostering a sense of accountability.

(4) Empowerment and Independence, Coaching leaders empower employees to make their own decisions and take ownership of thei r work, fostering a sense of autonomy and independence.

Disadvantages:

(1) This style can lead to toxic environments, as staff struggle for favoured roles and development tasks.

(2) Too much focus on long-term development can leave short-term projects without proper support.

(3) Need for Employee Buy-In: For coaching to be successful, employees must be motivated to develop and willing to receive feedback. If employees are not receptive to the process, it may not be effective.

(4) Time-Intensive: Coaching leadership requires significant time and energy due to the focus on individual employee development, potentially impacting other priorities.

3. Laissez-faire management styles

In this style, management takes a hands-off approach to leadership.

Staff is trusted to do their work without supervision, and they are left to control their decision making and problem-solving.

Management is present at the delegation and delivery stages of work, but otherwise steps back and gives staff the freedom to control their workflow and outcomes.

Management is only involved during the process if the staff requests their assistance. The substyles include:

a. Delegative management style

In this style, the manager is only present to assign tasks, although they still are responsible for tasks being completed successfully. Once the task is assigned, then the employees are empowered to do their work as they see fit.

After the task is complete, the manager steps back in to review the wo

rk and give advice about how to improve future projects.

Advantages:

(1) Innovation and creativity are fostered by this system, especially in organizations with highly skilled workers.

(2) Problem solving and teamwork are strengthened, as staff are gi ven space to handle their own issues and will work together to sol ve them.

(3) Job satisfaction may be increased in those who crave autonom y in their workplace.

(4) Increased Employee Autonomy and Empowerment: Delegating tasks gives employees more control and responsibility, boosting th eir confidence and job satisfaction.

(5) Improved Communication: Delegating effectively requires clear communication and open feedback, which can improve team dyna mics and relationships.

Disadvantages:

(1) Without leadership, productivity may suffer.

(2) Teams can experience a lack of direction, focus, or uniformity.

(3) Poorly managed conflicts may flare up and breed resentment.

(4) Some staff may feel that the management is not contributing a nything towards the team's success and become resentful.

(5) Ineffective with Weak Teams: The effectiveness of delegative lea dership depends on the team's competence, and struggling individ uals can hinder overall productivity.

b. Visionary management style

In this style, managers lead through inspiring their staff.

Leaders explain their goals and the reasons behind them, convincing t heir team to work towards executing their vision.

Team members are motivated by their manager, then allowed the freed om to achieve their tasks with minimal interference. Managers will che ck in from time to time, but they trust that their shared vision will keep employees on track and produce good results.

Managers offer a lot of constructive feedback during and after the pro cess to assist their employees, and make sure to give praise liberally.

Advantages:

(1) Engagement is heightened because staff believes in what they a re creating and are driven to complete tasks to the best of their abi lity.

(2) Employees are more satisfied, motivation is higher and turnover will be lowered.

(3) Innovation is higher, and problem-solving can happen quickly w ithin teams.

(4) Enhancing Strategic Thinking and Adaptability: Visionary leade rs possess a clear understanding of their industry and the external environment, enabling them to anticipate challenges, identify opp ortunities, and make strategic decisions.

(5) Strategic Focus: Visionary managers are strategic thinkers who develop a clear understanding of their industry and the organizatio n's place in it. They focus on long-term objectives and make decisi ons that align with the overall vision.

Disadvantages:

(1) Not all managers can be legitimately inspiring. It depends on th e job, the industry, the product, and the person.

(2) This is not a style that can be faked, employees must actually b e inspired, or they will not perform as well.

(3) Focus on the Future at the Expense of the Present: The strong e mphasis on the future can make it difficult to address immediate is sues or concerns, potentially leading to a neglect of short-term pri orities.

(4) Overly Dependent on the Leader's Personality: The vision's succ ess can become tied to the leader's personality, making it vulnerabl e if they leave or change.

(5) Dismissing Potential Ideas: Employees (visionaries) may becom e fixated on their vision, overlooking or dismissing potentially goo d ideas that don't align with their long-term goals.

MANAGEMENT IN LIBRARIES AND INFORMATION CENTRES

a. Importance of management in libraries and information centres

b. Librarian as an information manager

c. The changing roles of librarians in organization

Libraries are constantly evolving beyond physical books and documen t repositories, they have become hubs of diverse information formats, i ncluding digital resources, multimedia content, and online databases. Effective library and information centres management plays a pivotal r ole in enhancing the efficiency and productivity of a library, fostering a dynamic and streamlined environment for library staff and patrons.

Management of libraries enables learners to provide users with special ized skills in management of library resources covering leadership, hu man resource, strategic planning, personal and career development, c ustomer relations and organizational performance.

IMPORTANCE OF MANAGEMENT IN LIBRARIES AND INFORMATION CE NTRES

An efficiently managed information system ensures that resources are appropriately categorized, up-to-date, and easily accessible which em powers library staff to quickly and accurately assist patrons. Managem ent in libraries and information centres helps to;

1. Optimize available resources (utilizing the resources by organiza tion and integrating the resources in an effective manner)
2. Reduce redundancy (resources are coordinated, directed and co ntrolled in such a way that no resource is left out of use)
3. Minimize cost (Cost-effectiveness)
4. Promote efficiency (Time management)
5. Increase productivity within the library setting.

These enables libraries to fulfil their core mission of promoting knowle dge, learning, and information literacy within their communities.

LIBRARIAN AS AN INFORMATION MANAGER

Modern libraries require librarians to act like managers with appropriat e management techniques and principles. Librarians used to be consid ered as just the custodian of books and that the management of librar y required no professional competencies. A librarian manages a library like any other manager managing his organization. Thus, the role rema ins the same. Managing a library also requires basic skills as needed in case of any other commercial or industrial organization. But libraries b eing service-oriented organisations, the necessity of general and man agerial skills as core competencies of staff for effective management o

f libraries, flexible and decentralized organization, with empowered sta ff having the spirit of team work, interpersonal communication, shared vision, lifelong learning, etc. are obvious. Keeping these changes in mi nd it becomes essential for the library managers to have expertise and focus on the following areas of management:

1. Strategic Planning
2. User Centered Management
3. Technology Management
4. Project Management
5. Change Management
6. Entrepreneurship

The following skills are required by the library staff:

1. Library and information handling skills
2. ICT knowledge skills
3. Communication and training skills
4. Marketing and presentation skills
5. Knowledge mapping skills
6. Service orientation
7. Understanding of cultural diversity

Organizing Knowledge: A Deep Dive into Library Information Managem ent - Library & Information Science Education Network (lisedunetwor k.com)

THE CHANGING ROLE OF LIBRARIAN IN THE MODERN ERA

In the 21st century, the role of librarian and information professionals h

ave changed from book lending professionals to being an intermediary between information and its users. They play different roles like resear cher, information provider, advisor, trainer and specialist in order to me et the challenges posed by information technology (IT).

They should possess different skills such as computer skills, IT skills, c ommunication skill and networks skills and also learn about the latest technology trends such as digital, electronic and cloud computing. Tra ditional library is an ownership environment, whereas the modern libra ries are only access environment, the digital/electronic resource provi der are some other place. The librarian has to take the responsibility to provide access to all the users for better utilization of these resources. The advancement of information technology, digitization, and network s caused lot of changes in the Libraries and role of librarians. LIS profe ssionals are required to collect information in written, printed or electr onic format; and also to activate their use with the help of indexing an d reference work. Recent advances in IT have made it possible to store, analyse and disseminate information in various form and means of me dia on a local, national and international level. As a result, LIS professi onals are needed to shift their attention from collection (the objects) a nd look at the special services based on user-centric approach. The wi despread use of computer mediated information storage and retrieval system has made IT skill as 'survival skill' for the LIS professionals. The librarian should familiarize himself with recent technological innovatio ns and should have a clear understand of the needs of the users.

The role of a Librarians in the present electronic environment requires that they to work independently or as a team to deliver service-oriente d and user-centered applications, instructions, programme, projects a nd services. In addition to general qualification and requirements, a co mmitment to excellent user centered services, effective oral and writte n communications, as well as team collaborators must also possess ad ditional capabilities, experience, knowledge and skills such as:

1. Expertise in the use of innovative emerging technologies to desig n and develop web-based applications, program and services.

2. Assisting users to locate access, store and transforming electron ic information resources, services and instructions across multip le applications, databases, networks, platforms and systems thro ugh an academic library's information commons.

3. Having knowledge of designing, developing, launching and main taining of digital content management and assess, evaluate, reco mmend and test various methodologies, policies, and standards f or utilizing computer software in the process of creating and pre serving digital collections and resources.

4. Adaptability to changes fit to the requirements rather become bli nd follower of versatile technological developments.

Libraries play the following roles in modern society:

1. Promote the cultures of the communities they serve.

2. Meet the information needs of all categories of library users su ch as illiterates, literates, youths, children, elderly, persons with special needs, etc.

3. Facilitate formal, in-formal, self-education and development in the society

4. Collect and disseminate information resources thus fostering i ndependent and critical thinking .

5. Help to spread knowledge and culture across boarders

6. Conservation and preservation of human knowledge & culture for posterity and research.

7. Promote reading and enlighten the citizens, thus eradicate illit eracy .

According to LISBDNETWORK (2016), the functions of libraries ca n be categorized into four broad headings as recreation, informat ion dissemination, promotion of culture and education.

Recreation

Libraries play recreational role by helping their users to relax and reduce stress through making available resources such as motiva tional books, novels, newspapers, magazines, fiction films and e ducational games. These resources help library users not just to r elax but to also become voluntary readers which is vital for ling-l ong learning. In fact, libraries cater for the social-well-being of t he society and help to create the desire for reading in citizens. Th ey also provide social integration through organizing talks, films, and book exhibitions.

Information Dissemination

Libraries provide information to satisfy various/diversified needs of their users. They provide both general and specialized informa tion to both individuals and the public. They provide information on self-development, research, routine jobs, utility services politi cal issues and sports.

Promotion of Culture

Libraries promote culture of the people by providing information resources that portray their culture in good light. In other words, libraries help citizens to appreciate and accept other people's cul ture. Libraries provide resources that broaden user's horizon and enhance their intelligence.

Education

Libraries contribute to individual, group and national developme nt by supporting various forms of education with information res ources suitable for self-education, nomadic education, formal an d informal education. Libraries help to produce civilized individu als through granting citizens access to quality resources and enc ouraging them to read. A reading nation is a civilized nation and i nvariably a developed nation. Libraries serve as people's universi ty; a centre of mass education and a centre of continuing educati on.

Information explosion ushered in by the advent of information te chnologies caused a major challenge for information professiona ls on how to organize, preserve and disseminate such huge amou nt of information. Also, they were saddled with the challenges th at are associated with digitization and globalization of informati on such as: cyberspace, copyright, open-source software, digital preservation etc.

According to Sandhya (2012), apart from the basic qualification li brarians must also possess additional skills to enable them serve as:

1. Web Designers: Librarians should know how to design library p ortals. Library users can now access the resources of their librari es through their portals no matter their location as long as they have internet connectivity. The portal interface should be attracti ve to motivate users.
2. Facilitator: With the shift from print to digital resources and inf ormation explosion with its associated challenges such as the ne ed for ICT skills to be able to access relevant resources, librarians serve as facilitators in helping users acquire necessary skills in ef fective use of modern gadgets and software to locate and retriev e the widely dispersed information in the cyber space.

3. Information Management Consultants: Librarians can serve as consultants to information users and s. They can help users build and maintain personals and institutional information systems.
4. Consortia Manager: Librarians coordinate and manage the con sortia of many libraries, this includes their strategic planning, sy stems development and project management. They also serve as consortium's representatives with vendors for contracted produc ts and services.
5. Guide/Teacher/Educator/Trainer: Librarians are teachers. They teach information literacy. Information literacy is the ability to id entify, locate, evaluate and use needed information. Library users need information literacy skills especially as the world has evolve

d into a knowledge-based society. It is the librarians' duty to edu cate all library users and their immediate communities on where, how to find and evaluate information. There is a paradigm shift of librarians' role from custodians of knowledge to information spe cialists.

6. Custodians of Information: The library is a repository of all info rmation needed in a community. This is a challenging responsibil ity for librarians especially now that there is a migration from ph ysical format to electronic format of library resources. Librarians need to acquire new skills on the management of electronic reso urces. They also serve as information providers

breaking geographical barriers to deliver wide range of informati on to users.
7. Change Agents: Librarians these days are outspoken. They neg otiate with the government, community heads and heads of para statals and institutions for improved funding for enhanced librar y facilities, services and purchase of new technologies. They can also act as advocate by communicating news about library's pro grammes and services through newsletters, handbills and library websites. They handle legal issues such as intellectual property r ight and copyright.

8. Experts and Intelligent Agents: Librarians are not just informat ion experts; they are intelligent and are conversant with emergin g technologies. They can design and develop web-based applicat ions, programmes and services. They can solve problems relating to locating required information on the web. They can design, us e and instruct library users on how to use search engines. The lib rarians are the intermediaries between online retrieval systems a nd the end-users. They can assist users in database selection, for mulating useful queries and in evaluating the relevance of inform ation retrieved.
9. Custodians of Library Facilities: Librarians are custodians of hi ghly sophisticated gadgets especially in this digital era. They the

refore need IT skills to both operate and maintain this equipmen t.

Human Resource Planning

Human resource planning (HRP), is a strategic process that aims to co ntinuously and deliberately help individuals acquire new skills, knowle dge, and competencies. It's a journey of planned growth, encompassin g aspects such as planning, performance evaluation, feedback, trainin g, and the creation of development opportunities.

The overarching objective of HRP is to enhance the quality and perfor mance of the library and its employees.

Effective human resource planning helps organisations proactively ad apt and pivot their talent strategies for future needs.

Human resource planning helps organizations identify current and fut ure workforce needs as they relate to the overall strategic priorities for the company. It is the steps and processes that organizations take to p roperly plan their HR requirements and programs to ensure they are in alignment with the company's strategic plan.

Key components of Human Resource Development include:

(1) Training and Development: HRP involves identifying the training nee ds of employees and providing them with targeted learning opportunit ies to improve their job-specific skills and knowledge.

(2) Performance Management: HRP establishes performance appraisal systems and feedback mechanisms to help employees improve their p erformance and achieve organizational objectives.

(3) Career Development: HRP supports employees in creating and impl ementing career plans, offering opportunities for advancement and ski ll development.

(4) Organizational Development: HRP contributes to initiatives focusin g on improving the organization's structure, culture, and processes, en

suring alignment with strategic goals.

(5) Talent Management: HRP identifies and nurtures talent within the o rganization, preparing employees for future leadership roles.

(6) Succession Planning: HRP develops strategies to identify and prepa re potential successors for critical organizational positions.

(7) Learning and Knowledge Sharing: HRP encourages continuous emp loyee learning and knowledge-sharing, enabling the organization to a dapt to changing environments and challenges.

(8) Employee Engagement: HRP initiatives enhance employee engage ment, job satisfaction, and well-being.

(9) Performance Support: HRP provides resources and tools to support employees in their day-to-day work, ensuring they can access the info rmation and guidance they need.

Technology and Innovation: HRD explores using technology and innov ation to enhance learning experiences and streamline HRD processes.

Key steps in the human resource planning process

Here are the key steps in human resource planning that every organiza tion should know.

A place for data

Really savvy HR teams will even try to predict *multiple* possible future s, based on the occurrence (or not) of certain events or trends. For exa mple, what will we do if that major new legislation passes? What if it d oesn't?

Technology, of course, can help with this aspect of the planning proce ss. Using existing data to help make future predictions can increase th e likelihood that planning efforts will be reliable and valid.

Reviewing capabilities

Once an HR team has identified the predicted world of tomorrow, it th en can think about what capabilities the broader organization will nee d to thrive in that future environment, and how the HR team can help d evelop those capabilities. Maybe the organization is expected to need more experience in artificial intelligence or automation.

Assessing current state

HR planning also involves taking stock of where a company, its employ ees, and the HR team are currently. This may seem like an exercise in t he obvious, but many organizations have terrible understandings of th eir current capabilities and skills gaps or even their diversity numbers.

Developing a timeline and budget

Once a company has a firm grasp of where it is now and where it want s to be in the future, it can start to develop its roadmap and timeline. F or example, if a company believes it will need to significantly beef up it s AI expertise over the next five years, it should probably start learning about the top AI schools and industry-standard compensation for AI p rofessionals, and start developing job descriptions for key positions.

This all requires, of course, integrated planning between HR and financ e to ensure the company has adequately budgeted to achieve identifie d HR strategies and goals.

Measuring and monitoring progress

Finally, HR teams will need to identify metrics and create reporting cyc les to assess progress and facilitate intelligent changes to the plan as needed. This will ensure that resources are used in the most effective way possible, and that decisions are made based on objective data an d reasoning.

Implementation of HRP

The successful implementation of Human Resource Planning (HRP) is a transformative journey that empowers organizations to unlock their fu ll potential by nurturing the growth and development of their most val uable asset – their employees. HRP goes beyond conventional training

programs; it encompasses a holistic approach to elevating employees' knowledge, skills, attitudes, and performance. In this introductory expl oration of HRP implementation, we delve into establishing dedicated H RP units, fostering a constructive work culture, and implementing vari ous strategic practices. From performance appraisals and role analysis to training policies and organizational development, each facet is pivot al in creating a thriving ecosystem where employees and organization s thrive.

Implementing Human Resource Planning (HRP) in an organization invo lves a systematic and comprehensive approach to nurturing employee s' skills, performance, and overall growth. To establish an effective HRP program, the organization needs to set up a dedicated HRP unit and fo cus on various essential aspects. Here are key components that contri bute to the successful implementation of HRP:

a) Performance Appraisal: Performance appraisal is a systematic proce ss where employees' job performance is evaluated against predetermi ned criteria. It involves setting clear performance standards, collecting performance data, providing constructive feedback, and identifying ar eas for improvement. Effective performance appraisal helps recognize top performers, identify training needs, and motivate employees to en hance their productivity and contribution to the organization.

b) Role Analysis: Role analysis involves understanding the responsibilit ies and expectations of each employee's position within the organizati on. Optimizing stress levels ensures that employees are neither overbu rdened nor underutilized, striking a balance that allows them to perfor m at their best. Building linkages between individuals and teams foster s collaboration and ensures effective communication and coordination across departments. Granting autonomy allows employees to exercise their initiative and creativity, leading to innovative problem-solving an d decision-making.

c) Training Policies: Training policies focus on providing employees wit h the necessary skills and knowledge to excel in their roles. Organizati ons must identify specific training needs and develop comprehensive t raining programs. These programs may include on-the-job training, w orkshops, seminars, online courses, and external training sessions. Po

st-training evaluations help assess the effectiveness of the training an d its impact on employee performance.

d) Communication Policies: Effective communication is the backbone of a successful organization. A robust internal communication system ensures that information flows seamlessly between management and employees. Transparent communication builds trust and alignment, re duces rumors and misunderstandings, and fosters a sense of inclusion and engagement among the workforce.

e) Job Rotation: Job rotation is the planned movement of employees b etween different organizational positions or departments. This practic e exposes employees to diverse job roles, enabling them to gain new e xperiences, skills, and perspectives. Job rotation helps employees gro w professionally and enhances organizational adaptability and cross-f unctional collaboration.

f) Organization Development: Organization development is a proactive approach to bring about positive organizational changes. It involves ali gning the organization's structure, culture, and processes with its stra tegic goals. Emphasizing growth and self-development mechanisms e nsures the organization can adapt to external changes, technological advancements, and evolving market dynamics.

g) Awards, Rewards, and Incentives: Implementing a well-structured re wards and recognition system encourages employees to go the extra mile and perform at their best. It could include monetary incentives, p erformance-based bonuses, employee of the month awards, or other f orms of recognition that motivate and reinforce desired behaviors.

h) Organizational Culture: An organization's culture encompasses its v alues, beliefs, norms, and practices. Building a positive and nurturing work culture fosters employee satisfaction, engagement, and loyalty. A culture that encourages open communication, employee developme nt, and work-life balance creates a conducive environment for HRP init iatives to thrive.

The successful implementation of HRP is influenced by various factors such as management style, organizational environment, technology, a

vailable resources, and the organization's history and background. By focusing on these critical aspects and tailoring HRD practices to the or ganization's unique needs, an effective HRD program can drive employ ee development, engagement, and, ultimately, the organization's succ ess.

Organizational Structure of a Library

Organizational structure (OS) is the formal system of task and reportin g relationships that coordinates and motivates organizational member s to work together to achieve organizational goals (Khalfan &Waleed, 2 015). Furthermore, the structure of an organization shows the pattern of relationships between roles in an organization and its different part s. The purpose of the structure serves to allocate work and responsibili ty in order to direct activities and achieve the organization's goals. In t his way, the organizational structure concerns formal arrangement of t he responsibility and interaction between tasks, people and resources in an organization, and it is usually seen as a chart with positions or tit les and roles in a cascading order. Organisational structure has to do with the managing and recruiting the staff, training and developing the staff members, managing funds, and overall functioning of the library. This is supported by Hola and Pikhart, 2014 who stated that Organisati onal structure is a crucial bridge that connects various processes and activities of the organization towards the achievement of its' goals.

Factors Affecting Organisational Structures

Several factors affect organisational structures which include; environ ment, technology and the psychological characteristics of workers.

Environmental factors: An organisation is continuously interacting wit h its environment in terms of drawing inputs from it and providing its o utputs. All organisations operate within an environment which compri ses economic, social, cultural, political and legal subsystems. A chang e in any of these sub-systems may force change in the design of the st

ructure. The more responsive your organisation is to changes in the en vironment, the more favourable will be its public image and the greater the chances of its survival and success. Most libraries and information centres operate in complex and changing external environments whic h produce new challenges.

Technological factors: The second factor affecting the structure of an organisation is the technology that is adopted. With the introduction of automation and computerisation, new organisational structural des igns are necessitated. Libraries have been adopting a host of technolo gies like computers, compact storage, telecommunications; recognitio n technology, reprographics, micrographics, etc., and their impact on t he organisational structure is enormous. Many have felt that hierarchi cal structures can no longer satisfactorily meet the challenges of tech nology in libraries. The changes necessitated are redefining jobs and r edesigning existing departments to suit the new technological proces s. Above all, today the greatest impact of technology is on the manner in which people collect, receive and use information.

The changing psycho-social characteristics of the workers: Like great er demand for leisure time and formal recognition of unions - which le ad to the introduction of the five-day week, etc. are equally important in deciding the organisational structure. The three factors that we hav e discussed so far are external to the organisation and its managemen t.

Internal factors: An organization and its own members are responsible f or these factors. For example;

- Changes in personnel due to hiring, termination of employment, retirement, promotion, etc.
- Change of functional policy decisions like holidays, work hours, paid leaves, etc.
- Changes affecting physical facilities like usage of alternative raw materials or adaptation to new machinery.

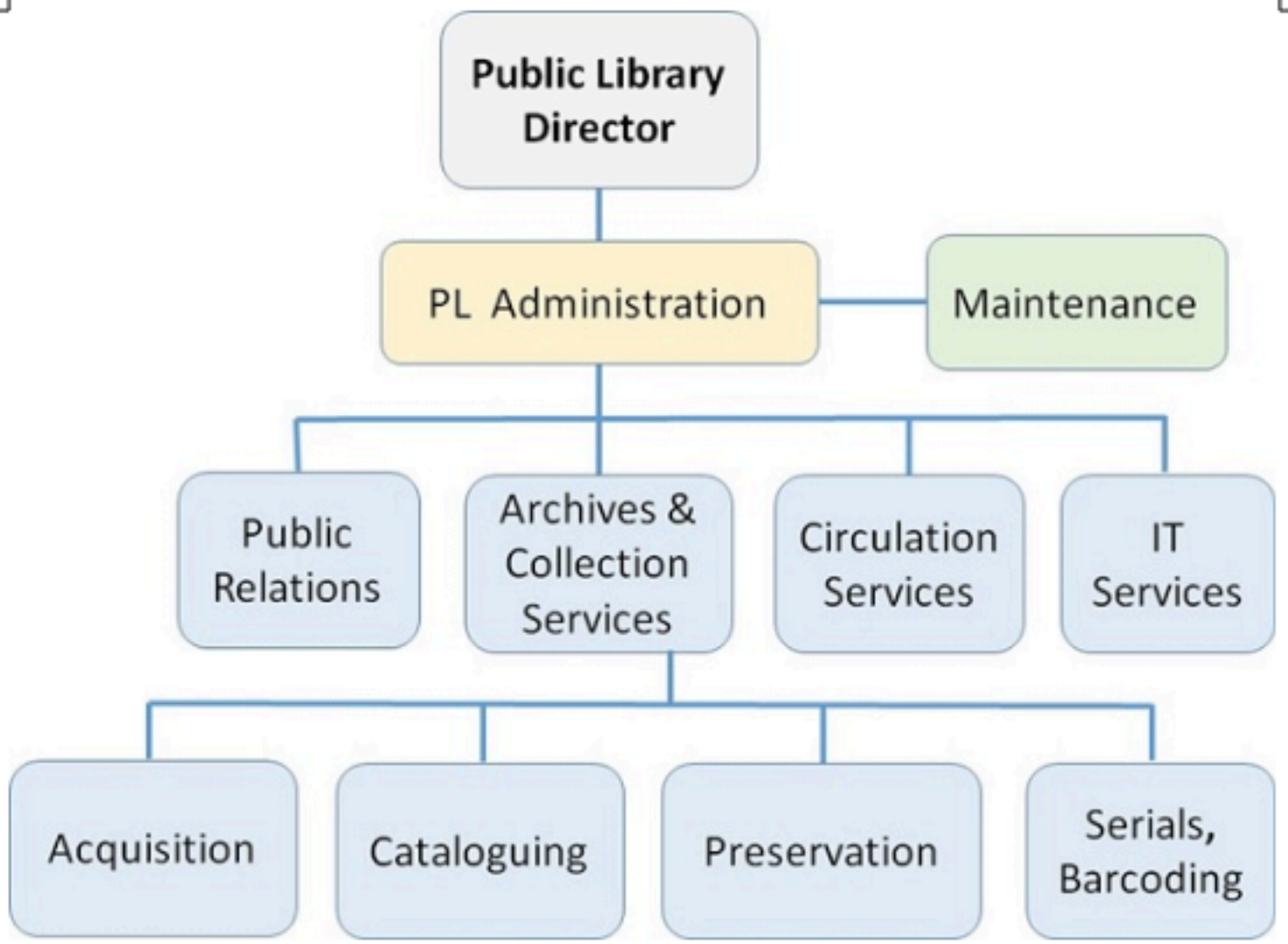
Within a public library, the number of departments can vary depending

upon its size, budget, space, and its strength in terms of the number of members.

Library management and administration is a multifaceted work of orga nizing, preserving, collecting, circulating, and maintaining the printed or digital resource of knowledge. It involves managing and recruiting t he staff, training and developing the staff members,managing funds, a nd overall functioning of the library.

Take a look at the following hierarchy chart. It shows the most basic or ganizational structure of a public library .

Organisational chart of a public library



Roles of Public Library Departments

The roles of various public library departments are as follows :

1) **Public Library Director** : Establishes strategies, policies, and goals.

2) **Public Library Administration :** Handles overall library operations, en forces policies set by director and planning.

3) **Maintenance :** Ensures smooth running of facilities by housekeepin g, and maintaining ground, electrical gadgets, and plumbing.

4) **Public Relations :** Engages into promotions, informing the public ab out upcoming events, crisis management.

5) **Archives and Collection Services :** Acquires, catalogues, manages, a nd preserves important records, sets serial numbers or barcodes, hand les the rare or fragile knowledge resources with due care.

6) **Circulation Services :** Manages issuing and receiving returned mater ial, tracks fines and dues by users due to late return or loss of material.

7) **IT Services :** Manages library network, computers, and audiovisual d evices, updates software.

Strategies for communication in library and information centres

According to Tabor (2010), Library communication is carried out withi n the library and in some cases between libraries. In communication, meaning and understanding between the people involved has to be es tablished. Communication in the library has two distinct levels which are:

a. Staff communication

b. Clientele and staff communication

Staff Communication: Communication among the staff of the library has an effect on the way the library is managed. Communication must flow upward and horizontally across the organization just as much as it flows downward. Regular meetings are held to discuss library polici es and implementation. Because the entire library staff cannot be at t hose meetings, heads of the various departments, sections or units an d other designated representatives will have to meet formally or infor mally and resolutions or decisions of such meetings made available to other members of staff for them to understand and comply with. Som e meetings are solely for the members of the top of the administrative hierarchy, and decisions that affect other staff are made known to the m.

Clientele and Staff Communication: Library users need communicatio n to achieve desired information-seeking goals. Communication is an exchange of information; it takes two or more to exchange informatio n. So when a user visits the library in search of information resources, and is helped by a reference librarian, communication takes place. At t his point, information is exchanged and obtained. The reference librari an is an assistant to information seekers, a translator of different infor mation sources, who queries users on what they need, and feeds the i nformation seeker with the desired materials to work with. The circula tion desk is another place where valuable communication takes place between the library staff and library clientele. They make their enquiri es at the circulation including borrowing and returning material. Anot her crucial kind of communication between staff and users is the publ icizing changes in policies and services. Lectures and exhibitions spo nsored by the library are announced in the university gazette and the official newsletters. Suggestion boxes are placed at strategic points a round the library may yield useful information that can be supplement ed by occasional user surveys. The library can also hold meetings wit h designated university officials when considering a collection develo pment in line with university programmes. The library can also make c onnections with other university libraries for services like interlibrary l oan.

Corporate Culture

The term "corporate culture" was described by Ampa and Mamza (201 1) as a set of common values, attitudes and behaviours which are perc eived as the way in which things are being done in the organization, th is include ethical standards, flexibility of management, creativity of em ployees, concern for public welfare, and the need for compliance with the law. It is a way of sharing beliefs, attitudes, assumptions and value s, which may not have been explicitly articulated. It is a very powerful i nstrument of change, because, it shapes the way people act and intera ct and strongly influences how things get done. According to Schein i n Ampa and Mamza (2011), corporate culture is learnt in two aspects; t he trauma model in which members of the organization learn to cope with using defence mechanism and the positive reinforcement model where things that work become embedded and adopted

Organizational/corporate culture is a collective understanding, a share d and integrated set of perceptions, memories, values, attitudes and d efinitions that have been learned over time and which determine expec tations (implicit and explicit) of behaviour that are taught to new mem bers in their socialization into the organization. That is to say, organiza tional culture is made up of the organization's potentials, practices, be liefs, and values that binds it together. It combines principles and man nerisms that add to the unique social and psychological environment of an organisation (Omeluzor, 2018).

Functions of Organisational Culture

Depending on how strong or weak an organisation's culture is, it may have implications for its structure. Thus, the following are some of the functions of organisational culture that have been recognised:

a. Culture is what distinguishes one organisation from another.

b. Assist in the development of a sense of devotion to something la rger than oneself.

c. Culture communicates a sense of identity and ensures the social system's stability.

d. Organisational culture acts as social glue, helping to keep the or ganisation together by advising employees on what they should do or say.

e. It acts as a sense-making and control mechanism, guiding and s haping employee attitudes and behaviour.